

Chair Tai Chi Workout Plan

A 28-Day Seated Program — Companion Guide

Your Chair

Use a sturdy, armless chair with a firm seat. Feet should rest flat on the floor. Avoid chairs with wheels. Keep open space around you so your arms can extend fully in all directions.

Move Slowly

All movements should be slow, continuous, and deliberate. There is no hurrying. Quality of movement matters far more than speed or the number of repetitions completed.

How Long

Week 1–2 sessions run approximately 15 minutes. Week 3–4 sessions run 20–25 minutes. Start your timer only after you are seated, settled, and composed.

Breathe First

Inhale as you open, expand, or lift. Exhale as you close, contract, or lower. Breath drives movement in Tai Chi — never hold it. If you feel dizzy, pause and breathe normally.

Honor Rest Days

Rest days are not gaps in the program — they are part of it. Use them to notice how your body feels. Light walking is welcome. Stillness and integration are the point.

Safety First

Consult your physician before beginning this or any exercise program. Stop and rest immediately if you feel pain, dizziness, or shortness of breath. Every exercise can be modified.

1

WEEK ONE

Rooting

~15 min/day

2

WEEK TWO

Flowing

~15 min/day

3

WEEK THREE

Expanding

~22 min/day

4

WEEK FOUR

Integrating

~25 min/day

This guide is for informational purposes only and is not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Individual results vary. Movements are adapted from traditional Tai Chi principles for seated practice.

The Movements

Part One — Warm-Up, Tai Chi Forms & Strength exercises. All performed seated.

Seated March

WARM-UP

Lift alternating knees slowly, arms swing gently opposite. Keep spine tall.

Neck Rolls

WARM-UP

Chin to chest, roll right ear to shoulder, back to center, then left. Never roll fully backward.

Arm Circles

WARM-UP

Arms at shoulder height — slow circles forward 10×, then backward 10×. Breathe continuously.

Ankle Rolls

WARM-UP

Lift one foot, rotate ankle 5× each direction. Repeat other side. Grounds awareness.

Cloud Hands

TAI CHI

Sweep both hands slowly left to right as if moving clouds. Torso rotates gently, elbows soft.

Ward Off (Peng)

TAI CHI

Arms rounded as if embracing a ball. Push outward with one forearm while other curves below.

Parting Wild Horse's Mane

TAI CHI

One hand rises to shoulder (palm down), opposite descends to hip (palm up). Alternate sides.

Brush Knee

TAI CHI

One hand sweeps low past opposite knee while other pushes forward at chest height. Flow continuously.

Repulse the Monkey

TAI CHI

Draw one hand to ear while opposite reaches forward, palm out. Alternate sides gently.

Wave Hands in Clouds

TAI CHI

Like Cloud Hands with more torso rotation and a figure-8 path. Hands always move in opposition.

Seated Leg Lifts

STRENGTH

Straighten one knee to floor-parallel, hold 3 sec, lower. 10 reps each side.

Shoulder Shrugs

STRENGTH

Inhale: shoulders to ears. Exhale: drop completely. Feel the full contrast. 10 reps.

Chest Opener

STRENGTH

Fingers interlaced behind head, open elbows wide, inhale and lift chest. Hold 3 sec. 8–12 reps.

Goddess Squat

STRENGTH

Sit at edge, feet wide, slowly rise to hover, lower with control. 10–15 reps.

Seated Row

STRENGTH

Arms extended, draw elbows back squeezing shoulder blades. Hold 2 sec, return slowly. 10–12 reps.

The Movements

Part Two — Balance, Stretching, Advanced & Closing exercises.

Single Leg Hold

BALANCE

Hands lightly on thighs, lift one foot 2–3 inches, hold still. Breathe. Repeat other side.

Toe Taps

BALANCE

Tap each toe forward, out to side, back to center. Slow and controlled each direction.

Forward Fold

STRETCH

Sit at edge, hinge at hips and drape torso toward thighs. Breathe into the lower back.

Cat-Cow Stretch

STRETCH

Hands on knees. Inhale: arch back, lift chest. Exhale: round spine, drop chin. Flow slowly.

Eagle Arms

STRETCH

Cross one arm under the other at elbows, wrap forearms, lift to shoulder height. Upper back opens.

Seated Twist

STRETCH

Hand on opposite knee, other behind on seat. Inhale tall, exhale and rotate. Look over shoulder.

Hip Opener

STRETCH

Ankle over opposite knee (figure-4). Sit tall, lean gently forward from hips.

Hamstring Stretch

STRETCH

Extend one leg straight, flex foot, reach toward toes with long spine. Do not round back.

Warrior I (Seated)

ADVANCED

Sit sideways on chair edge, rear leg extended back, front knee at 90°. Arms sweep overhead.

Pigeon Pose (Seated)

ADVANCED

Ankle over opposite knee, foot flexed. Sit tall or lean gently forward. Deep hip stretch.

Gathering Qi

CLOSING

Arms wide, sweep hands inward to belly as if gathering energy. Traditional Tai Chi closing.

Seated Savasana

CLOSING

Hands in lap, eyes closed, breathe naturally. Notice stillness and warmth. The most important move.

28-Day Schedule

All four weeks at a glance. Rest days marked 休. Check each day as you complete it.

WEEK	DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Wk 1 <i>Rooting</i> ~15 min	1 Seated March Arm Circles Ankle Rolls Neck Rolls Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	2 Seated March Shoulder Shrugs Cat-Cow Stretch Cloud Hands Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	3 Neck Rolls Arm Circles Seated Leg Lifts Toe Taps Forward Fold Seated Savasana	4 休	5 Seated March Ward Off (Peng) Chest Opener Cloud Hands Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	6 Arm Circles Seated Twist Shoulder Shrugs Brush Knee Forward Fold Seated Savasana	7 休
Wk 2 <i>Flowing</i> ~15 min	8 Seated March Cloud Hands Goddess Squat Hip Opener Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	9 休	10 Neck Rolls Parting Wild Horse's Seated Row Cat-Cow Stretch Eagle Arms Seated Savasana	11 Arm Circles Repulse the Monkey Seated Leg Lifts Single Leg Hold Forward Fold Seated Savasana	12 休	13 Seated March Wave Hands in Brush Knee Chest Opener Seated Twist Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	14 休
Wk 3 <i>Expanding</i> ~22–25 min	15 Seated March Cloud Hands Ward Off (Peng) Goddess Squat Hip Opener Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	16 休	17 Neck Rolls Toe Taps Warrior I (Seated) Repulse the Monkey Eagle Arms Seated Savasana	18 Arm Circles Wave Hands in Seated Row Pigeon Pose (Seated) Cat-Cow Stretch Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	19 Seated March Parting Wild Horse's Single Leg Hold Hamstring Stretch Brush Knee Seated Savasana	20 休	21 Neck Rolls Cloud Hands Goddess Squat Chest Opener Hip Opener Gathering Qi Seated Savasana
Wk 4 <i>Integrating</i> ~22–25 min	22 Seated March Ward Off (Peng) Wave Hands in Warrior I (Seated) Pigeon Pose (Seated) Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	23 Arm Circles Parting Wild Horse's Seated Row Hamstring Stretch Seated Twist Seated Savasana	24 Neck Rolls Repulse the Monkey Goddess Squat Single Leg Hold Eagle Arms Hip Opener Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	25 Seated March Cloud Hands Brush Knee Wave Hands in Forward Fold Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	26 休	27 Arm Circles Warrior I (Seated) Parting Wild Horse's Pigeon Pose (Seated) Cat-Cow Stretch Chest Opener Gathering Qi Seated Savasana	28 休